

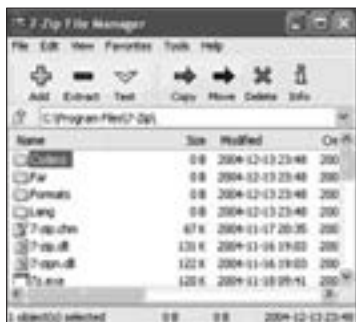
sion. The Expert Layout feature gives added choices, auto signature and commenting. Then there is Cryptozip—a tool to encrypt compression files.

Another feature is the presets for actually making backups of your most important directories and files on your system. Clicking the Backup menu area shows choices like Windows Registry files, etc., and it has a small, simple and effective inbuilt FTP program.

5.3.3 7-Zip

(www.7-zip.org)

7-Zip is a file archiver with a very high compression ratio. The compression ratio is claimed to be 2–10% better than the ratio provided by PKZip and WinZip. It integrates fully with the Windows environment. Its 7z format files have self-extracting capability.



7-Zip works in Windows 98/ME/NT/2000/XP. There is port of the command line version for Linux/Unix. 7-Zip (except for the file Rar29.dll) is free software distributed under the GNU Lesser General Public License. The file Rar29.dll is under a mixed license, as it is used to re-create the RAR compression algorithm, which is proprietary.

The interface gives a very comfortable feel. It is well-laid out, and almost explanatory about its usage. Excellent for novices.

Compression ratio results are dependent upon the data used for the tests. Usually 7-Zip compresses to 7z format 30–70 % better than the Zip format. And 7-Zip compresses to Zip format 2–10 % better than most other Zip-compatible programs.